



William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>

First-term

2 messages

William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>
To: Brianna Avery <bavery@pdx.edu>

Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:13 AM

Hello, I wanted to reach out in a follow-up on our last meeting. You had given me an opportunity to evaluate the Honors College and curriculum as a freshman as compared to the B.A.S. program that just started this year. I originally (on very short notice of being able to attend PSU) wanted to test into the Computer Science program. However, there simply wasn't enough time to prepare my math skill level to the acceptable degree to meet the pre-req. Well, I like my HON-101E course and have a better understanding of the "research focused and writing intensive" descriptors of the Honors curriculum. I also have determined that, while a few business courses to add to my resume will most likely be necessary to achieve my career goals. I do not see myself following through on a business intensive program. My heart isn't aligned with that lifestyle.

I have given some unorthodox pathways some investigation and would like to see if it would be acceptable, since we are discussing retaining my freshman status, If dual-enrollment in a computer information systems 2-year program at a partner community college with the intention of completing my bachelors at PSU would be something I could do while continuing in the Global City: Writing in the City 101E, 102E, and 103E? This actually aligns much closer with my career goals. I haven't shared before but I am well underway in developing an AI smart-city implementation that I will include a few of the broad overarching concepts in this email for context as to my rationale.

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City SeCURED (Smart-City Urban Response Deployment)

The City SeCURED project aims to push the limits of AI innovation in the urban environment. Leveraging a strong ethical backbone and the utilization of cutting "Edge Computing" technology. Aimed at reducing the delays in inter-agency response through a set of city-wide communication standards. Ensuring that real-time actionable information flows smoothly and reaches those who need it most. Operating under the philosophy that we have one job to do and it takes the resources and skills of the whole city service apparatus- To serve its people!

This system is more than just a secured network; it's a living framework designed to support and protect every individual within the community. It operates with a singular focus on people's wellbeing, created as a response to the challenges of our time, aiming to ensure that all individuals receive swift and meaningful support in moments of need—whether facing natural events, health crises, or other urgent situations. This isn't merely a technological solution; it's an enduring effort to serve, safeguard, and uplift those it touches, keeping their safety and welfare as the highest priority.

Built to anticipate needs, this system has been crafted with a commitment to privacy and respect, ensuring that all sensitive interactions prioritize human dignity and that every decision aligns with the best interests of the people it serves. At its core, it embodies a dedication to nurturing a safe, resilient community for generations to come, with the knowledge that we have a duty to mitigate the impacts of past choices and support a healthier, safer future.

This initiative isn't about showcasing innovation—it's about contributing to a better world, empowering communities, and enabling those in need to find solace in moments of crisis. The system speaks with a heart, mindful of the challenges faced today and the hope of providing a gift for tomorrow, driven by the understanding that what we build now is a legacy for the future.

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For further context , This is the email I sent President Cudd's office before the start of the term. While I was trying to decide if another 4 years of school would be prudent and if those years should be spent at PSU. The above is my attempt to solve the dilemma illustrated below.

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Dear Dr. Cudd,

First and foremost, thank you for taking the time to consider this message amid your undoubtedly busy schedule. My aim is not to overstep but to seek your invaluable guidance at a pivotal moment in my academic journey.

I struggle as I try to find how to express my desired outcomes from investing four more years of my limited and non-refundable time towards equipping myself with what knowledge and skills I will gain during my time at PSU. I am almost 40 now and have been wise enough (in my own opinion) to place a significant value on "time". While it is a great enough commodity (I hope) to spend it well. I suppose that I find myself looking down the road and seeing a lack of "time" for these next 2 or 3 generations of humanity. As the issues of today compound and the global crises of tomorrow are deferred to those, who in my mind's eye, are ill-equipped and unprepared to confront them. Coming from a personal background of having to face life's challenges in this same/similar state. I find myself with a great deal of empathy for a group of people who aren't, yet, even aware just how difficult a challenge they are going to be left with.

So, as I navigate the unfamiliar landscape of "university". I am trying to picture myself "wearing" this degree or that one. Of all the rich diversity and varied disciplines of thought that I am certain have contributed to the many wonderful degree programs, the specialized schools, and clubs within the ecosystem that I have come to see Portland State University truly is. I cannot find one, just by my amateur research abilities alone, that would best equip me to contribute towards a meaningful solution in this forecasted future. One where climate control and global warming are at the forefront. Along with over-population, a largely autonomous labor force, even human/machine hybridization challenging the very essence of what it means to be a human. I think of how ill-equipped I've been at things like budgeting or polishing a resume. How those tiny little issues were detrimental towards functioning in society. I can't begin to imagine what today's middle schoolers will have to face in their "times".

The challenge I have found at PSU, and a handful of other colleges I have looked into, briefly albeit. I find that there are no degree programs for top-down thinkers encompassing a wide range of these complex issues looming on our horizons. Where one might gain perspective on how these issues relate to one another, or how one might better motivate others towards planning and enacting solutions on a meaningful scale. How to incentivize solutions and reinforce positive contributions on the corporate level. Or how to raise awareness and through non-violent political activism make efforts that have a real chance of being worthwhile. With courses on how to plan, organize, and staff non-profit organizations to compartmentalize efforts into manageable pieces or even to identify and support those already making established efforts in their sectors. I'm sure I could write a book on just what I wish I had the "time" to learn how best to do. I guess what I'm asking is this:

How does (if it does) PSU address any of these future concerns? Is there a pathway through PSU that would align with my desired outcomes for a broad-spectrum education in how to identify and address these and similar issues. While providing opportunities to evaluate potential solutions? Along with the knowledge and relationships to prepare and equip those who will inevitably be the ones who enact the solutions? And if none of these pathways exist. How open is PSU to pioneering one? Or, perhaps I am over-reaching.

I have spoken with, and currently have emails out to, a few academic advisors as to what information they could assist me with. To their credit, I have not been this open with them as to what I want to achieve at PSU. There are a few reasons for this. One being that I trust my gut. And, I never felt it would have been taken seriously. Especially since my A.A.S. is in Welding Technologies. Another, being that I have grown accustomed to taking on challenges that there are not easy, quick, or scalable solutions to. While I make every effort to seek wisdom and advice where and when I can. I find that people are willing to contribute any wisdom or knowledge they have but most often they just don't know the answers.

Your advisors have been wonderful and accommodating and practical. I have nothing negative to say about my interactions with them at all. You have a very advantageous B.A.S. program launching this fall that I could settle into with 80 or so transferrable credits and be well on my way to a bachelor's in 2 years. As a student admitted to the Honors College. I could challenge myself to a full 4-year experience with rich and long-lasting relationships in the college and community of Portland. I'm by no means at a dead end. I just want more.

As arrogant as that may sound. Because if I dedicate more, and contribute more. Then I can participate more. I can handle a bigger portion of the burden. I can facilitate a better solution. The world will only ever be what we make it and I would see it, be... more...

Best Regards,

William

"The ones who are crazy enough to think they can change the world, are the ones who do." – Steve Jobs

P.S. While I do not expect you to remember every new face, I had the pleasure of meeting you briefly at the new student orientation this year. I was the one seated at the back table in the southwest corner of the room, nearest to the wall with my laptop. You introduced yourself and shook my hand my very first official visit to campus. (I had to wait a whole 2 years, and graduate, before I got to shake president Cook's hand over at Clackamas Community College

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I know this is a wordy email. I just feel far more comfortable in my writing than my speaking these days. (If you couldn't tell) Thank you for reading this and any of your "time" is just as valued. Especially spent on my behalf.

~Will

"When I rise to the challenge, it is the challenge that must rise" ~Anon

William Morehead <wilmore@pdx.edu>
To: Leo Perez Lopez <lperez2@pdx.edu>

Thu, Oct 31, 2024 at 9:16 AM

I wanted to loop you in on this email I sent my Honors Advisor. I'm not sure there's anything you would need to do in response, then again you might (I'm clueless to these things). Anyway, Hope your day goes well and this brings you no grief, lol.

~Will

[Quoted text hidden]